

PrepMax Logistics

User Manual

A complete guide to the customer portal and the staff admin panel.

Covers: shipments & tracking, quotes, complaints, contacts, finance/invoicing, manifests, de-manifests, staff & permissions, and analytics.

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About This Manual

The Portal of PrepMax Logistics is used in two ways:

- The Customer Portal - where the customer's customers create shipments, track packages, request quotes, raise complaints, and view their invoices and payment history.
- The Staff / Admin Panel - where the admin's team creates and manages orders, handles finance (invoices, vendor bills, payments, expenses), builds manifests for carrier hand-offs, receives inbound shipments (de-manifests), and manages staff accounts and permissions.

This manual is split into two parts. Part 1 covers the Customer Portal. Part 2 covers the Staff / Admin Panel. Each section walks through the screen, the fields on it, and the exact steps to complete a task.

Note: Every branch's data is kept separate. Branch managers only see their own branch's customers, orders, and finance records. A super-admin can see and switch between all branches.

Part 1 - Customer Portal Guide

1. Getting Started

1.1 Requesting an account

New customers do not sign themselves up directly -They register from the form,then an account request is sent to the branch for approval. This keeps every customer tied to a real, verified business relationship.

1. Go to the account request page (linked from the login screen).
2. Fill in the customer's name, business/company details, contact info, and the branch the customer want to work with.
3. Submit the request.
4. A staff member reviews it and approves or rejects it.
5. Once approved, the customer can log in with the email and password the customer registered with.

1.2 Logging in

Go to the portal login page and enter the customer's email and password. A session cookie keeps the customer signed in; use "Log out" from the account menu to end the customer's session on a shared device.

1.3 Portal layout

After logging in the customer will see a sidebar with the following sections:

- My Orders- create and order request and track orders
- Quotes - request a shipping rate quote
- Complaints - raise and follow up on an issue
- Finance - invoices, payment history, and the customer's outstanding balance
- Manifests - hand off a batch of the customer's shipments to PrepMax in one go

2. Shipments (Orders)

2.1 Creating a shipment

From My Orders, place new booking and fill in the following:

Field	What it means
Sender / Receiver	Name, company, phone, email, CNIC/NTN (optional), and full address (line 1, line 2, city, state, country, postcode) for both parties.
Origin / Destination country	The route the shipment travels.
Service type & level	Standard, Express, Economy, or Freight.
Contents nature	Documents or Merchandise.

Field	What it means
Duties	DTP (Duties/Taxes Paid) or DTU (Duties/Taxes Unpaid).
Handling flags	Any special handling notes (e.g. fragile).
Boxes	One or more boxes - each with a label, parcel type (package, document, pallet, fragile, oversized, other), weight (kg), and dimensions (L×W×H cm). Add line items inside a box for customs (description, quantity, declared value, HS code, country of origin) if needed.
Price / currency	Shown once staff price the shipment; a new shipment usually starts unpriced.

6. Add sender and receiver details.
7. Add at least one box with its weight and dimensions.
8. Choose the service type/level and any handling flags.
9. Review and submit. The customer's shipment is created with status Pending Approval.

2.2 Shipment statuses

Status	What it means
Pending Approval	Just created; waiting for staff to review and accept it.
Awaiting Carrier	Approved, but not yet handed to a carrier (no tracking leg attached yet).
Active	A carrier has been attached and the shipment is in transit; tracking updates automatically.
Delivered	Confirmed delivered by the carrier's tracking feed.
Cancelled	The shipment was cancelled.

2.3 Tracking a shipment

Open a shipment from My Orders to see its live status, or use the public tracking page with just the tracking code/AWB number - no login required, so the customer can share it with the receiver.

Note: For the customer's protection, the portal never shows which external carrier is actually handling the customer's package, only PrepMax Logistics status text is shown.

2.4 Downloading documents

From a shipment's detail page the customer can download:

- Receipt PDF - proof of booking with the customer's charges.

3. Contacts

Contacts is the customer's saved address book, so the customer does not have to retype sender/receiver details on every shipment.

- -Customers can save contacts while filling the form for order booking.

4. Quotes - Request a Shipping Rate

If the customer want a price before booking, request a quote instead of creating a shipment directly.

10. Go to Quotes → New Quote Request and describe what the customer want shipped (route, weight, service level, etc.).
11. Submit. The request appears in the customer's Quotes list with status New.
12. Staff will respond with a price - status changes to Quoted.
13. Use the message thread on the quote to ask follow-up questions in real time.
14. Accept or Decline the quote once the customer is ready.

Status	What it means
New	Submitted, not yet reviewed.
Quoted	Staff has responded with a price.
Closed	The request is closed out.

5. Complaints

Use Complaints to raise any issue with a shipment or service.

15. Go to Complaints → New Complaint and describe the issue (the complaint is linked to a specific shipment).
16. Submit. It appears in the customer's list with status Open.
17. Staff will respond - the customer will see it move to In Review and can chat back and forth on the message thread in real time.
18. Once addressed, staff mark it Resolved, and then Closed.

6. Finance - The customer's Account

The Finance section of the portal is read-only and shows only the customer's own records:

- Summary - the customer's current outstanding balance (what the customer owe PrepMax), and whether any invoice is overdue.
- Invoices - every invoice raised to the customer, with status (Unpaid / Partial / Paid / Void) and a downloadable copy of each.
- Payment History - every payment PrepMax has recorded against the customer's account, with date, amount, and which invoice it was applied to.

Note: Credit notes (refunds/adjustments) reduce the customer's outstanding balance automatically and show in the customer's invoice list marked "Credit Note".

7. Manifests - Hand Off a Batch of Shipments

If the customer regularly hand over multiple shipments at once, the customer can bundle them into a manifest instead of tracking each one individually.

19. Go to Manifests → New Manifest.
20. Add any of the customer's own shipments to the manifest (search by tracking number).
21. Submit while it's still Open - the customer can keep adding shipments until staff picks it up for processing.
22. **Note:** The carrier on the customer's manifest always shows as "Prepmax Logistics" - the customer is handing the customer's batch to PrepMax, who will then assign the real downstream carrier internally. The customer will not see or need to know which external carrier is used.

8. Edits- Modifying a placed order

23. When a customer places an order and it goes for approval, the customer can edit the order until the order is approved.
24. Once the order is approved, customers can no longer edit the details of it and must contact PrepMax Logistics to request for any changes .

Part 2 - Staff & Admin Guide

8. Roles & Access

There are two Default staff roles:

Role	Access
Super Admin	Full access to every branch and every module. Can create branches, manage staff, and toggle permissions for other roles.
Branch Manager	Scoped to a single branch. Sees and manages only that branch's customers, orders, finance, manifests, and complaints. Access to individual modules is controlled by permissions (see §9).

Note: Every table in the system is branch-isolated at the database level , a branch manager physically cannot query another branch's data, even by accident.

9. Staff Accounts & Permissions

9.1 Managing staff

Super Admin → Staff lets the admin:

- View all staff accounts across branches, with their assigned roles.
- Edit a staff member's details or branch assignment.
- Deactivate or delete a staff account.
- Create a new branch manager account for a branch.

9.2 Permissions

Super Admin → Permissions shows a grid of every module and a toggle per role. Enabling a module for a role grants that role's staff access to it (both the sidebar link and the underlying data, since the check is enforced by the backend, not just hidden in the UI). Modules include:**Note:** A Super Admin implicitly has every permission and doesn't need anything toggled on.

- Accounts
- Branches
- Finances
- Complaints
- Customers
- Manifest
- De-manifest
- Orders
- Quotes
- Roles
- Tracking

10. Account Requests

New customer sign-ups land here first.

25. Go to Account Requests. Each pending request shows the applicant's details and branch.
26. Review the details.
27. Approve to create the customer account (they can now log in), or Reject.

11. Orders (Shipments) - Staff View

Admin → Orders is the master list of every shipment for the admin's branch (or all branches, for Super Admin).

11.1 Creating an order for a customer

28. Click New Order (and select the branch, if Super Admin).
29. Fill in sender/receiver, service type, boxes, and pricing, same fields as the customer-side form, plus the admin can set price, payment status (unpaid/paid/partial), and amount paid directly.
30. Save. The order is created directly (staff-created orders skip the "pending approval from customer" concept).

11.2 Approving a customer-submitted order

Orders submitted by customers appear in the Order Requests queue with status Pending Approval. Open one and click Approve to move it to Awaiting Carrier, or Cancel to reject it.

11.3 Attaching a carrier (activating tracking)

31. Open the order and go to Carrier Legs.
32. Attach a carrier + tracking number (up to 2 legs, e.g. a local pickup leg + an international carrier leg).
33. Once the legs are attached, the order automatically moves to Active and an estimated delivery window is calculated from the service level and carrier.
34. The admin can edit a leg's carrier/tracking number, or (Super Admin only) delete a leg entirely.

11.4 Editing, cancelling, syncing

- Edit - update any field on an order (boxes replace the previous set entirely when provided).
- Cancel - sets the order to Cancelled.
- Sync - manually pull the latest tracking status from the carrier immediately, instead of waiting for the automatic poller.
- Delete - permanently removes an order (used sparingly; prefer Cancel for normal workflow).

12. Customers

Admin → Customers lists every customer for the branch. The admin can:

- View a customer's profile and their order history.
- Edit their contact/business details.
- Deactivate or delete a customer.

13. Vendors (Carriers & Partners)

Vendors are the carriers and partners the admin pay - e.g. APX, SkyNet, DHL, or a local courier. They sit under Finance → Vendors.

35. Click New Vendor.
36. Choose the vendor type: Carrier (pick from the known-carrier list so it lines up with tracking), Local, or Other.
37. Fill in contact details and an opening balance if the admin already owes them money from before using this system.
38. Save.

From the vendor list the admin can also:

- View their Ledger - a running statement of every bill and payment (see §15.3).
- Toggle Active/Inactive with the power icon.
- Hard-delete a vendor ,permanently removes the vendor along with all their bills and payments. Requires typing the vendor's name to confirm; this cannot be undone.

14. Finance Module

Finance is the bookkeeping layer for the branch: accounts receivable (what customers owe), accounts payable (what the admin owe vendors), cash/bank tracking, and reporting. It has eight tabs: Dashboard, Bank Accounts, Vendors, Customers, Invoices, Vendor Bills, Payments, Expenses, and Reports.

14.1 Dashboard

A snapshot of branch finances, optionally filtered to a date range:

Field	What it means
Total Income	Money actually received from customers (cash-basis, not just invoiced).
Total Expenses	Operating expenses plus money paid out to vendors.
Profit / Loss	Income minus expenses.
Pending Payments (AR)	Total still owed to the admin across unpaid/partial invoices.
Pending Vendor Bills (AP)	Total the admin still owe vendors.
Cash in Hand / Bank Balance	Running balance per cash or bank account, shown per named account.

Below the summary cards the admin will find charts (income vs. expenses, AR vs. AP, cash vs. bank) and a per-account balance breakdown.

14.2 Bank Accounts

Before recording any payment or expense, set up at least one Cash and/or Bank account here.

39. Click New Account.
40. Choose Type: Cash or Bank.
41. Name it (e.g. "Cash in Hand", "Meezan Bank - Main"). For a Bank account, also pick the bank from the list and optionally enter the account number.
42. Set an opening balance if the account didn't start at zero.
43. Save.

Every payment and expense the admin later record must be posted against one of these named accounts, so the running balance per account stays accurate. Use the power icon to deactivate an account the admin no longer use (its history is kept).

14.3 Customer & Vendor Ledgers

A ledger is a running statement - every debit and credit for that party, in date order, with a running balance:

- Customer Ledger (Finance → Customers → Ledger): invoices are debits (they owe more), payments received are credits. A positive closing balance means the customer owes the admin money.
- Vendor Ledger (Finance → Vendors → Ledger): vendor bills are credits (the admin owe more), payments the admin make are debits. A positive closing balance means the admin owe the vendor money.

Note: Ledgers are calculated live from invoices/bills/payments - there's no separate ledger to keep in sync, so the numbers are always correct.

14.4 Invoices

44. Go to Invoices → New Invoice.
45. Pick the customer (and branch, if Super Admin) and, optionally, the order it relates to.
46. Add one or more line items - description, quantity, and unit price. The subtotal and total (including tax) calculate automatically.
47. Set issue date, due date, and currency, then save.

To issue a Credit Note (a refund or adjustment that reduces what the customer owes), choose Type → Credit Note when creating the invoice, and optionally pick which invoice it corrects. A credit note cannot exceed the remaining balance of the invoice it credits.

From the invoice list the admin can filter by status (Unpaid / Partial / Paid / Void), edit an invoice, void it (keeps it for audit history - financial records are never hard-deleted once paid against), or delete it outright if nothing has been paid against it yet.

14.5 Vendor Bills

A vendor bill is what a carrier/partner charges the admin - the accounts-payable equivalent of an invoice.

48. Go to Vendor Bills → New Bill.
49. Pick the vendor, bill date, due date, and currency.
50. Add line items with a description and amount (the bill number is generated automatically).
51. Save. The bill starts Unpaid.

14.6 Payments

Every money movement - received from a customer or paid out to a vendor - is recorded here.

52. Go to Payments → Record Payment.
53. Choose Direction: Received (from customer) or Paid out (to vendor).
54. Choose Method: Cash, Bank, Cheque, Online, or Other.
55. Choose the Cash/Bank account the money moved through , only accounts matching the chosen method are shown (choosing "Cash" only lists the admin's cash accounts; any other method only lists bank accounts).
56. Enter the amount, date, and for a received payment , the customer and which invoice it should be allocated against; for a paid-out payment, the vendor and which bill it settles.
57. Save. The parent invoice/bill's paid amount and status (Unpaid → Partial → Paid) update automatically.

Note: The system blocks recording a payment larger than what's actually still owed on the selected invoice or bill.

14.7 Expenses

58. Go to Expenses → New Expense.
59. Choose a category: Office Rent, Salaries, Fuel, Utilities, Marketing, or Miscellaneous.
60. Enter the amount, choose the cash/bank account it was paid from, the date, payee, and a description.
61. Save. Filter the expense list by category using the tabs at the top.

14.8 Reports

Go to Reports and choose a period: Daily, Monthly, or Yearly. Each row shows income, vendor payments, operating expenses, and the net result for that period - useful for spotting trends at a glance.

15. Manifest Module (Outbound)

A manifest is the formal hand-off document when the admin give a batch of shipments to a carrier. Its lifecycle is Open → Closed → Dispatched.

62. Go to Manifests → New Manifest.
63. Optionally choose a carrier/vendor for the whole batch (one carrier per manifest).
64. The manifest is created Open with zero shipments.

65. Add shipments - search by tracking number or scan a barcode; the admin can bulk-select. The system automatically blocks adding an order that's already sitting on another active manifest, so nothing gets double-booked.
66. Totals (shipment count, total weight) update automatically as the admin add or remove shipments, using each order's existing box weights.
67. When the batch is finalized, click Close ,the manifest locks and can no longer be edited.
68. Once physically handed over, click Dispatch - this records the hand-off time and frees those orders so they could, in principle, appear on a future manifest again if needed.

From the manifest detail page the admin can Print the manifest PDF, or export the shipment list as CSV/Excel.

15.1 Manifests created by customers

Customers can create their own manifests from the portal (see Part 1 §7). These arrive with the vendor auto-set to the customer's house "Prepmax Logistics" vendor and are flagged so the customer can tell they came from a customer. The customer can re-assign the real downstream carrier on the manifest at any time using the normal Edit flow , the customer will continue to see it labelled "Prepmax Logistics" regardless.

16. De-Manifest Module (Inbound Receiving)

A de-manifest is the reverse of a manifest - receiving a batch from a carrier and reconciling what actually arrived against what was expected.

69. Go to De-Manifests → New De-Manifest.
70. Enter the courier name (or pick a vendor), the arrival hub (defaults to the customer's branch), and - if the customer have it - link the originating manifest so the system knows what's expected.
71. Scan or type each arriving shipment's tracking number as it's physically received.
72. For each shipment scanned, record its condition: Good, Damaged, Missing, or Open Package.
73. The system automatically reconciles each scan:
 - A scan matching an expected shipment → marked Received.
 - A scan that doesn't match anything expected → marked Extra (an unexpected/unrecognised parcel - the customer can still record a manual sender/receiver/destination for it).
 - Anything on the expected list that's never scanned → marked Missing once the customer complete the de-manifest.
74. Add remarks on any individual shipment as needed.
75. Once done, click Complete - this locks the de-manifest and finalizes any still-pending rows as Missing.

From the de-manifest detail page the admin can also export the shipment list as CSV or Excel, the same as for manifests (§15).

17. Complaints - Staff View

Admin → Complaints lists every complaint filed by customers in the customer's branch.

76. Open a complaint to see the details and the full message thread.

77. Reply on the thread - the customer sees the customer's reply live.

78. Update the status as the customer work it: Open → In Review → Resolved → Closed.

18. Quotes - Staff View

Admin → Quotes lists customer rate requests.

79. Open a quote request.

80. Reply with a price (Quoted Price + currency) and any notes on the message thread.

81. Staff and Customer can have real time chat as well.

82. Status updates to Quoted; the customer can then Accept or Decline it.

20. Analytics Dashboard

Admin -> Analytics gives a branch-wide KPI overview, separate from the Finance Dashboard in §14.1 (that one only covers bookkeeping totals; this one covers orders, shipments, and revenue trends together). Choose a look-back window (7-365 days) and the page shows:

- KPI totals - total orders, delivered, active, pending approval, and exceptions, plus revenue and total unpaid amount.
- Orders and revenue per day - a day-by-day chart across the chosen window.

21. Custom Roles

Beyond toggling permissions on the two built-in roles (§9.2), a Super Admin can also create additional named roles from Super Admin -> Permissions:

- Click New Role and give it a name (e.g. "Warehouse Staff" or "Read-Only Auditor").
- The new role appears in the permissions grid with everything unchecked; toggle the modules it should have access to, same as any other role.
- Assign it to a staff member the same way as Super Admin or Branch Manager, from Staff Accounts (§9.1).
- Delete a custom role from the same list; staff who held it are simply left with no role until reassigned. The two built-in roles (Super Admin, Branch Manager) cannot be deleted.

Note: Creating and deleting roles is Super Admin-only, same as the permissions grid itself, a Branch Manager can be assigned a custom role but cannot create or delete one. Custom roles are global (not tied to a single branch); a Branch Manager assigned one is still restricted to their own branch's data as usual.

22. Notifications

Staff receive live, branch-scoped notifications (new complaints, new quote requests, new messages, order requests) via a bell icon in the admin header. Notifications update in real time without needing to refresh the page.

23. Settings

The Settings module is divided into three sections: **Permissions**, **Branches**, and **Staff Accounts**.

23.1 Permissions

The Permissions section is visible only to the Super Admin. No other staff member can view or manage permissions. From here, the Super Admin controls which modules each role can access throughout the system.

23.2 Branches

Branches can only be created, edited, or deleted by the Super Admin. Staff with the Branches permission can view only their own assigned branch and edit its details if that permission allows it. They cannot view or manage any other branch.

23.3 Staff Accounts

Staff Accounts is available to users who have the required permission. Staff with access can create, edit, or delete staff accounts if their permissions allow it. However, only the Super Admin can create a new Branch Manager account or change a staff member's branch assignment. No other role can perform these actions

Status References

Order status

Status	Meaning
pending_approval	Newly submitted, awaiting staff review.
awaiting_carrier	Approved, no carrier attached yet.

Status	Meaning
active	Carrier attached; tracking live.
delivered	Delivered, per carrier tracking.
cancelled	Cancelled.

Invoice / Vendor Bill status

Status	Meaning
unpaid	Nothing paid yet.
partial	Some, but not all, has been paid.
paid	Fully paid.
void	Cancelled but kept for audit history.

Manifest status

Status	Meaning
open	Editable - shipments can be added/removed.
closed	Locked, ready for hand-off.
dispatched	Physically handed to the carrier; timestamp recorded.

De-Manifest status

Status	Meaning
open	Receiving/scanning in progress.
completed	Finalized; unscanned expected items marked Missing.

Quote status

Status	Meaning
new	Submitted, not yet reviewed.
quoted	Staff responded with a price.
closed	Closed out.

Complaint status

Status	Meaning
open	Just filed.
in_review	Staff is working it.
resolved	Issue addressed.
closed	Closed out.